of manufacturing companies filing returns in the year 2018–19 also went up to 1,33,691 compared to 1,30,672 companies that had filed returns for 2017–18.

Data from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) indicates that 10,004 companies were registered in the month of August 2019. In September 2019, this number went down to 9,171. It started growing significantly from December 2019 when it went up to 12,057 companies. In January 2020, the highest number of companies were registered in financial year 2019–20 at 12,429. From February 2020, however, the impact of COVID-19 started and the registration of new companies went down to 10,429. It collapsed to 5788 in March 2020 when lockdown was imposed. The month of April 2020 saw the lowest registrations in many years at 3209. Registration activity resumed from June 2020 and flourished from July 2020 onwards when as many as 16,487 companies were registered. Registrations remained quite high, in excess of 16,000 per month, from July to October with registration peaking at 16,707 in October 2020. There was somewhat subdued activity thereafter, though still much higher than in these months in previous years. As economic activity has not picked up much during 2020–21, high registrations since June 2020 seem to indicate that the conversion of non-corporate businesses into companies is taking place.

There were 2,27,260 active manufacturing companies in India at the end of March 2019 as per the MCA data. This number had reached 2,32,932 at the end of August 2019 and 2,34,356 at the end of September 2019, the month when corporate tax rates were slashed to only 15 per cent for new manufacturing companies. As 7096 companies were registered in six months, the average increase in active manufacturing companies can be taken at about 1,150 per month.

The number of active manufacturing companies increased to 2,39,681 by March 2020, recording an increase of only 5325 in six months after the